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MATHEMATICAL PAPERS.

London: C. J. CLAY & SONS,
CAMBRIDGE UNIVERSITY PRESS WAREHOUSE,
AVE MARIA LANE.

Cambridge: DEIGHTON, BELL AND CO.
Leipzig: F. A. BROCKHAUS.

THE COLLECTED
MATHEMATICAL PAPERS

OF

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VOL. III.

CAMBRIDGE:
AT THE UNIVERSITY PRESS.

1890

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AT THE UNIVERSITY PRESS.

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THE present volume contains 64 papers numbered 159 to 222 originally published in the years 1857 to 1862: the chronological order is slightly departed from for the sake of including a series of papers in the Memoirs and the Monthly Notices of the Royal Astronomical Society; there are thus some earlier papers which have been left over for the next volume.

As papers are referred to by their Numbers only it will be convenient to give in each volume a Table such as the following:

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159.

ON SOME INTEGRAL TRANSFORMATIONS.

[From the *Quarterly Mathematical Journal*, vol. I. (1857), pp. 4–6.]

SUPPOSE that x, a, b, c and x', a', b', c' have the same anharmonic ratios, or what is the same thing, let these quantities satisfy the equation

$$\begin{vmatrix} 1, & 1, & 1, & 1 \\ x, & a, & b, & c \\ x', & a', & b', & c' \\ xx', & aa', & bb', & cc' \end{vmatrix} = 0;$$

this equation may be represented under a variety of different forms, which are obtained without difficulty; thus, if for shortness

$$K = a(b' - c')(x' - a') + b(c' - a')(x' - b') + c(a' - b')(x' - c'),$$

then

$$\begin{aligned} Kx &= -\{bc(b - c)(x' - a') + ca(c - a)(x' - b') + ab(a - b)(x' - c')\}, \\ K(x - a) &= (c - a)(a - b)(b' - c')(x' - a'), \\ K(x - b) &= (a - b)(b - c)(c' - a')(x' - b'), \\ K(x - c) &= (b - c)(c - a)(a' - b')(x' - c'). \end{aligned}$$

Consider x, x' as variables; then

$$K^2 dx = (b - c)(c - a)(a - b)(b' - c')(c' - a')(a' - b') dx';$$

let d, d' be any corresponding values of x, x' ; then

$$\begin{vmatrix} 1, & 1, & 1, & 1 \\ a, & b, & c, & d \\ a', & b', & c', & d' \\ aa', & bb', & cc', & dd' \end{vmatrix} = 0$$

and we have

$$K(x-d) = D(x'-d');$$

where

$$D = (c' - a')(a' - b')(b' - c') \Lambda,$$

and

$$\Lambda = \frac{(a-d)(b-c)}{(a'-d')(b'-c')} = \frac{(b-d)(c-a)}{(b'-d')(c'-a')} = \frac{(c-d)(a-b)}{(c'-d')(a'-b')}.$$

Suppose $\alpha + \beta + \gamma + \delta = -2$; then

$$(x-a)^\alpha(x-b)^\beta(x-c)^\gamma(x-d)^\delta dx = J(x'-a')^\alpha(x'-b')^\beta(x'-c')^\gamma(x'-d')^\delta dx',$$

where

$$J = (b-c)^{\beta+\gamma+1}(c-a)^{\gamma+\alpha+1}(a-b)^{\alpha+\beta+1}(b'-c')^{\beta+\gamma+1}(c'-a')^{\gamma+\alpha+1}(a'-b')^{\alpha+\beta+1} D^\delta.$$

We may in particular take for a', b', c', d' the systems b, a, d, c ; c, d, a, b and d, c, b, a respectively; this gives, writing successively y, z, w instead of x ,

$$\begin{aligned} (x-a)^\alpha(x-b)^\beta(x-c)^\gamma(x-d)^\delta dx &= M(y-a)^\beta(y-b)^\alpha(y-c)^\delta(y-d)^\gamma dy \\ &= N(z-a)^\gamma(z-b)^\delta(z-c)^\alpha(z-d)^\beta dz \\ &= P(w-a)^\delta(w-b)^\gamma(w-c)^\beta(w-d)^\alpha dw, \end{aligned}$$

where

$$\begin{aligned} M &= (a-b)^{\alpha+\beta+1}(c-d)^{\gamma+\delta+1}, \\ N &= (-)^{\alpha+1}(a-c)^{\alpha+\gamma+1}(b-d)^{\beta+\delta+1}, \\ P &= (a-b)^{\alpha+\beta+1}(a-c)^{\alpha+\gamma+1}(b-d)^{\beta+\delta+1}(c-d)^{\gamma+\delta+1}; \end{aligned}$$

the relations between the variables x, y, z, w being

$$\begin{aligned} x &= \frac{(c+d)ab - (a+b)cd - (ab-cd)y}{ab-cd - (a+b-c-d)y} \\ &= \frac{(b+d)ac - (a+c)bd - (ac-bd)z}{ac-bd - (a+c-b-d)z} \\ &= \frac{(a+d)bc - (b+c)ad - (ad-bc)w}{ad-bc - (a+d-b-c)w}. \end{aligned}$$

These are, in fact, the formulæ in my note, "On an Integral Transformation," *Camb. and Dubl. Math. Jour.* t. III. (1848), p. 286 [62], which was suggested to me by Gudermann's transformation for elliptic functions, (*Crelle*, t. XXIII. (1846), p. 330).

Suppose now that the values of a', b', c', d' are 0, 1, ∞ , ζ , we have in this case

$$x = \frac{a(b-c) + c(a-b)y}{(b-c) + (a-b)y},$$

and representing the denominator by K , then

$$\begin{aligned} K(x-a) &= -(a-b)(a-c)y, \\ K(x-b) &= (a-b)(b-c)(1-y), \\ K(x-c) &= (a-c)(b-c), \\ K(x-d) &= (a-b)(c-d)(y-\zeta), \end{aligned}$$

where

$$\zeta = \frac{(a-d)(b-c)}{(a-b)(c-d)},$$

and we have

$$K^2 dx = (a-b)(a-c)(b-c) dy,$$

whence

$$\begin{aligned} (x-a)^\alpha (x-b)^\beta (x-c)^\gamma (x-d)^\delta dx \\ = -(-)^\alpha (a-b)^{\alpha+\beta+\delta+1} (a-c)^{\alpha+\gamma+1} (b-c)^{\beta+\gamma+1} (c-d)^\delta y^\alpha (1-y)^\beta (y-\zeta)^\delta dy. \end{aligned}$$

It is easy, by means of this equation, to generalise a remarkable formula given by M. Serret in his memoir, “*Sur la Représentation géométrique des Fonctions elliptiques et ultra-elliptiques*,” *Liouville*, t. XI. and XII. [1846 and 1847], and *Recueil des Savans étrangers*, t. XI. [1851]¹. In fact, suppose that the indices $\alpha, \beta, \gamma, \delta$ are integers, and that two of these indices, e.g. γ, δ , are negative, the remaining two indices being positive, then writing $-\gamma, -\delta$ instead of γ, δ the integral

$$\int \frac{(x-a)^\alpha (x-b)^\beta dx}{(x-c)^\gamma (x-d)^\delta},$$

where $\gamma + \delta = \alpha + \beta + 2$, depends on the integral

$$\int \frac{y^\alpha (1-y)^\beta dy}{(y-\zeta)^\delta}.$$

Suppose that the fraction under the integral sign is resolved into simple fractions, each of these fractions will be integrable algebraically, except the fraction having for its denominator the simple power $y - \zeta$, the integral of which is a logarithm. The coefficient of this fraction is at once found by writing in the numerator $\zeta + (y - \zeta)$ for y ; and expanding in ascending powers of $y - \zeta$ and equating this coefficient to zero, we have

$$\left(\frac{d}{d\zeta}\right)^{\delta-1} \zeta^\alpha (1-\zeta)^\beta = 0,$$

which [observing that $(\gamma - 1) + (\delta - 1) = \alpha + \beta$] is easily seen to be equivalent to

$$\left(\frac{d}{d\zeta}\right)^{\gamma-1} \zeta^\beta (1-\zeta)^\alpha = 0.$$

¹M. Serret has reproduced the theorem in his very interesting and instructive treatise, “*Cours d’Algèbre supérieure*,” deuxième édition, Paris, 1854, [quatrième édition, Paris, 1877].